

■ Custom WordPress Plugin + Divi 5 Module Development Playbook

Complete Best Practices, Tools & Workflows

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What This Is: Everything you need to build professional WordPress plugins and Divi 5 custom modules. Official docs, boilerplates, security standards, testing frameworks, CI/CD, deployment — all in one place.

Part 1: WordPress Plugin Development

Official Documentation

Resource	URL
Plugin Developer Handbook	https://developer.wordpress.org/plugins/
Security Handbook	https://developer.wordpress.org/apis/security/
Coding Standards	https://developer.wordpress.org/coding-standards/
Block Editor Handbook	https://developer.wordpress.org/block-editor/
REST API Handbook	https://developer.wordpress.org/rest-api/

Pro tip: Append `?output_format=md` to any wordpress.org page for LLM-friendly Markdown.

Best Boilerplate: DevinVinson/WordPress-Plugin-Boilerplate (7.8K ■)

The gold standard. Clean OOP architecture with admin/public separation, activator/deactivator hooks, i18n support.

```
plugin-name/
├── plugin-name.php      # Main file
├── admin/               # Admin hooks
├── includes/           # Core logic
├── public/              # Frontend hooks
└── languages/          # Translations
```

Security: 5 Guiding Principles

1. Never trust user input
2. Escape as late as possible
3. Escape everything from untrusted sources
4. Never assume anything
5. Validation/rejection > sanitization

Every PHP file must start with: `defined('ABSPATH') || exit;`

Key functions: `current_user_can()`, `wp_nonce_field()`, `sanitize_email()`, `esc_html()`, `esc_url()`, `wp_kses_post()`, `$wpdb->prepare()`

Modern PHP Standards

- PSR-4 autoloading via Composer
- PHP 7.4 minimum (WP 7.0 requirement)
- Namespaces: `MyPlugin\Admin\ClassName`
- WPCS via PHP_CodeSniffer: `vendor/bin/phpcs --standard=WordPress`

Testing

- **PHPUnit:** `wp scaffold plugin-tests` → `vendor/bin/phpunit`
- **wp-env:** `npm install -g @wordpress/env` → `wp-env start`

- WordPress Playground: wordpress.org/playground — WebAssembly, no install needed

CI/CD

- GitHub Actions: Test matrix (PHP 7.4 + 8.2 × WP 6.5 + latest)
- SVN Deploy: [10up/action-wordpress-plugin-deploy](#) (655 🟩)
- Build: `wp dist-archive ./ my-plugin.zip`

Part 2: Divi 5 Custom Module Development

Key Architecture Change

Divi 5 is a **full React rewrite**. Divi 4 shortcodes → React components + JSON blocks. `create-divi-extension` is **deprecated**.

Best Resources

Resource	Type
16wells.github.io/divi-docs	LLM-friendly, exhaustive API/module docs
divilovewp/divi5-skill	15 <code>.md</code> skill files for JSON-native generation
oaris-dev/diviops	MCP server + WP plugin for Divi 5
Squad Modules Lite	65+ free Divi 5 modules — best reference implementation
cjsimon2/Divi5-Toolkit	CSS generation, WCAG, CWV

Divi 5 Module Registration (Conceptual)

```
registerModule({
  name: 'my-custom-module',
  title: 'My Custom Module',
  attributes: {
    title: { type: 'string', default: 'Hello' },
    color: { type: 'string', default: '#000' }
  },
  render: ({ attributes }) => (
    <div style={{ color: attributes.color }}>
      <h2>{attributes.title}</h2>
    </div>
  )
});
```

ACF + Divi 5

- ACF PRO required for Repeater, Flexible Content, ACF Blocks
- [acf-mcp-server](#) for JSON-first field group management
- Divi 5 Dynamic Content pulls ACF values → Loop Builder displays repeater data

Part 3: Development Environment

Tool	Best For
LocalWP	Quick WP sites, non-technical use
EnvKit (429 🟩)	AI-driven dev, built-in MCP server
wp-env	Plugin/theme dev, automated testing
WordPress Playground	Instant testing, zero install

IDE Setup

- **Cursor:** Composer 2.5 (60%), Grok 4.5 (25%), DeepSeek V4 (10%), GLM 5.2 (5%)
- **VS Code:** PHP Intelephense, WP Snippets, Xdebug, PHPCS

Quick-Start: New Plugin From Scratch

```
wp scaffold plugin my-plugin
composer init --name="jonbeatz/my-plugin" --type="wordpress-plugin"
composer require --dev wp-coding-standards/wpcs phpunit/phpunit
wp scaffold plugin-tests my-plugin
wp-env start
vendor/bin/phpcs --standard=WordPress .
vendor/bin/phpunit
composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader
wp dist-archive ./ my-plugin.zip
```

Plugin & Module Dev Playbook v1.0 · July 17, 2026 Sources: Official WP docs, GitHub repos (7.8K+ ) , Divi 5 community resources, 10up CI/CD tools